Week 1 Training: Mastering Claude.ai for Content Writing

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DAY 1: Meet Claude: Setup, Interface & First Conversations

Today's objective: Get your account running, understand how Claude works at a high level, and have your first real conversations.

1.1 What is Claude?

Claude is an AI assistant made by Anthropic. Think of it as a very knowledgeable writing colleague who is available 24/7. You type messages to Claude, and it responds in natural language.

Key things to understand upfront:

- **Claude is conversational.** You don't need special commands or code. Talk to it like you'd message a coworker on Slack.
- **Claude is stateless across conversations.** Every time you start a new chat, Claude has no memory of previous chats. Within a single conversation, it remembers everything you've discussed.

- **Claude is not a search engine.** It doesn't browse the internet in real-time. Its knowledge comes from training data, which means it can be outdated on fast-changing topics (like Shopify app pricing).
- **Claude can be wrong.** It sometimes generates confident-sounding text that contains factual errors. This is called "hallucination." You will learn to spot and handle this.

Why this matters for your job: You'll be writing about Shopify apps — a space where features, pricing, and availability change frequently. Claude is excellent at helping you write faster and better, but it cannot replace your research and fact-checking.

1.2 Account Setup

Step-by-step:

1. Go to **https://claude.ai** in your browser
2. Click **"Sign up"**
3. Sign up with your work email (or Google account if preferred)
4. Verify your email
5. You'll land on the main chat screen — you're ready to go

Understanding the plans:

Plan	What you get	Best for
Free	Limited messages per day, access to Claude Sonnet	Trying it out
Pro ($20/month)	Much higher limits, access to Claude Opus (most capable), Projects feature	Daily professional use
Team ($25/user/month)	Everything in Pro + team collaboration, admin controls	Teams working together

> **Recommendation:** Start with Free to learn. Upgrade to Pro once you're using it daily — the higher message limits and access to the more capable model are worth it for professional content work.

- [x] **Task: Create your account and confirm you can access the chat screen.**

1.3 The Claude.ai Interface - A Guided Tour

When you log in, here's what you see:

The Main Screen

- **Left sidebar** — Your conversation history. Every chat you start is saved here. You can rename conversations, delete them, or search through them.
- **Center area** — The chat window. This is where you type messages and read Claude's responses.
- **Message input box** — At the bottom. Type your message here and press Enter (or click the send button) to send.
- **Model selector** — Near the input box or at the top. You can choose which Claude model to use.

Models — Which Claude Should You Use?

Claude comes in different versions (models), like different "brains":

Model	Speed	Quality	When to use
Haiku	Very fast	Good for simple tasks	Quick questions, simple rewrites, brainstorming
Sonnet	Fast	Great for most tasks	Daily writing work, outlines, drafts, editing
Opus	Slower	Best quality & reasoning	Complex articles, nuanced tone work, strategy

> **Rule of thumb for your work:** Use **Sonnet** for 80% of your daily tasks. Switch to **Opus** when you need higher quality output for important pieces or complex topics. Use **Haiku** for quick throwaway tasks like generating title variations.

Key Interface Features

- **New chat button (+)** — Starts a fresh conversation. Claude forgets everything from previous chats.
- **Attachment button (paperclip icon)** — Upload files (documents, images, PDFs) for Claude to read and reference.
- **Copy button** — Appears on Claude's responses. One click copies the entire response.
- **Retry button** — Regenerates Claude's last response. Useful when you're not happy with the output.
- **Edit your message** — You can click on your sent message to edit and re-send it. Claude will regenerate its response based on your edited message.
- [x] **Task: Explore the interface. Click through the sidebar, find the model selector, and locate the attachment button. Spend 5 minutes just clicking around.**

1.4 Your First Conversations

Now you'll have your first real exchanges with Claude. Follow each exercise exactly, then reflect on what happened.

Exercise 1.1 — Say Hello

Open a new chat and type:

Hi, I'm Phương. I'm a content writer and I'll be writing articles about Shopify apps.
This is my first time using Claude. Can you briefly introduce yourself and explain
how you can help me with content writing?

After Claude responds, notice:

- How natural the response sounds
- Claude acknowledges your specific context (content writing, Shopify apps)
- Claude offers specific ways it can help
- [x] **Done? Write down one thing that impressed you and one thing that surprised you.**

One thing that impressed me

The positioning is clear.

All models returned results quickly, and the content matched relatively well.

All results focused precisely on Shopify app content writing, mentioning very practical tasks such as SEO, outline, product review, comparison post, HTML/Markdown formatting, internal linking…

Especially in Opus 4.6, the answers clearly divided into groups of skills: Research, Writing, Visual, and Formatting. Claude also mentioned specific products, Joy Loyalty and Chatty (possibly because this Claude account had previous conversations mentioning these two apps), creating a sense of specificity and avoiding the vague feeling that it was written solely by AI.

One thing that surprised me

The prompt didn't mention style or voice, but Claude's answers did, possibly. For Chat GPT or other tools, AI tends to respond safely and fairly neutrally. But here, it proactively simulated a higher-than-normal level of context awareness.

Exercise 1.2 — Test Contextual Memory

In the **same conversation**, type:

What's my name and what will I be writing about?

What's happening: Claude remembers everything within a conversation. It should correctly recall your name and that you write about Shopify apps.

Now **open a brand new chat** (click the + button) and type:

What's my name?

What's happening: Claude won't know your name because new chats start with zero memory. This is the most important concept to internalize — **every new chat is a blank slate.**

- [x] **Done? You now understand the difference between within-chat memory and across-chat memory.**

Exercise 1.3 — Your First Content Request

Open a new chat and type:

Explain what Shopify apps are, as if you're explaining to someone who just opened their first Shopify store yesterday. Keep it under 150 words.

After Claude responds, evaluate the output like an editor:

- Is it accurate?
- Is it the right tone for a beginner audience?
- Is it under 150 words?
- Would you publish this as-is? Why or why not?

Now, in the same chat, type:

Good, but make it more conversational — like a friendly blog post, not a textbook.

And add a specific example of a popular Shopify app to make it more concrete.

What you're learning: Claude adapts to feedback instantly. Your job is to direct it, just like you'd give revision notes to a junior writer.

- [x] **Done? Save both versions. Write a note about how the output changed after your feedback.**

After the feedback, the tone shifted noticeably from neutral and explanatory to warmer and more conversational. The first version sounded clear and helpful, but slightly instructional. It's like a simple guide written to inform. In the revised version, the language became more relaxed and friendly, using phrases like "Nice!" and "Seriously," which made it feel more like a casual blog post than a mini lesson.

The second version also added a concrete example: Judge.me. Including a specific, recognizable Shopify app made the explanation more tangible and practical, rather than abstract.

=> The revision improved personality, relatability, and specificity while still keeping the explanation simple and easy to understand.

Exercise 1.4 — Ask Claude Something It Might Get Wrong

Open a new chat and type:

What are the top 5 Shopify apps by number of reviews in 2025?
List the app name, developer, and number of reviews for each.

After Claude responds:

1. Go to the Shopify App Store (https://apps.shopify.com)
2. Check if Claude's answers are accurate
3. Note what it got right and what it got wrong

This is critical. You will almost certainly find errors — wrong review counts, outdated rankings, maybe even apps that don't exist. This exercise exists to build a healthy skepticism early.

- [x] **Done? Write down specifically what Claude got wrong. Keep this list — you'll reference it on Day 4.**

top 5 Shopify apps:

- Judge.me Product Reviews App
- DSers AliExpress Dropshipping
- TikTok
- Privy - Pop Ups, Email, & SMS
- Loox - Product Review App

Claude provided a list including Judge.me Product Reviews App, DSers AliExpress Dropshipping, TikTok, Privy - Pop-Ups, Email, & SMS, and Loox - Product Review App. All of these apps have incorrect number of review. The discrepancies are significant, indicating they are outdated. Even Privy and Loox have incorrect names displayed on Shopify.

Day 1 Checklist

- [ ] Account created and working
- [ ] Interface explored — know where sidebar, model selector, and attachments are
- [ ] Completed Exercise 1.1 (first hello)
- [ ] Completed Exercise 1.2 (memory test)
- [ ] Completed Exercise 1.3 (first content request + revision)
- [ ] Completed Exercise 1.4 (fact-checking test)
- [ ] Written reflections on all exercises

DAY 2 — The Art of Prompting: How to Talk to Claude

Today's objective: Learn the prompting techniques that separate a mediocre Claude user from an expert one. By the end of today, you'll write prompts that get publication-quality output on the first or second try.

2.1 Why Prompting Matters

Here's the reality: **Claude's output quality is directly proportional to your prompt quality.**

A vague prompt produces generic content. A well-crafted prompt produces content that sounds like you wrote it yourself. The difference is not Claude — it's you.

Think of it this way: if you asked a freelance writer “write something about Shopify,” you’d get garbage. If you gave them a detailed brief with audience, tone, angle, word count, and examples — you’d get something usable. Claude works the same way.

2.2 The Five Pillars of Effective Prompting

Pillar 1: ROLE — Tell Claude Who to Be

Starting your prompt with a role sets the expertise level and perspective.

Without role:

Write about email marketing for Shopify stores.

With role:

You are a senior e-commerce content strategist who has helped 200+ Shopify merchants grow their stores. Write about email marketing for Shopify stores.

The second version produces more authoritative, specific, experienced-sounding content.

Roles useful for your work:

- “You are a Shopify app reviewer who has tested 500+ apps”
- “You are a content strategist for an e-commerce blog targeting small business owners”
- “You are an SEO specialist who focuses on Shopify-related keywords”
- “You are a Shopify store owner who has been running a dropshipping business for 3 years”

Pillar 2: CONTEXT — Give the Background

Claude doesn’t know your audience, your brand, or your publication unless you tell it.

Without context:

Write a blog post introduction about PageFly.

With context:

I'm writing for a blog that targets small-to-medium Shopify store owners (mostly non-technical, 1-50 employees). Our readers are looking for practical, actionable advice — not jargon.

Write a blog post introduction about Avada apps.
The article will cover how Avada apps help merchants create custom landing pages without coding. Our reader's main pain point is that Shopify's default themes feel too limited for their brand.

Pillar 3: SPECIFICS — Be Precise About What You Want

The more constraints you give, the better the output.

Specify these whenever possible:

Element	Example
Word count	“Write 200 words” or “Keep it between 150-200 words”
Tone	“Professional but approachable” or “Casual and witty”
Format	“Use H2 subheadings and bullet points” or “Write in short paragraphs (2-3 sentences each)”
Audience	“For beginner Shopify store owners” or “For experienced e-commerce managers”
Goal	“The goal is to get the reader to try the free plan” or “This should educate, not sell”
What to avoid	“Don’t use jargon” or “Avoid clichés like ‘game-changer’ or ‘take your store to the next level’”

Pillar 4: EXAMPLES — Show, Don’t Just Tell

If you want Claude to match a specific writing style, **show it an example.**

Here's a paragraph from one of our published blog posts. Match this tone and style:

"Running a Shopify store is a bit like spinning plates. You've got inventory to manage, customers to keep happy, and marketing campaigns that won't run themselves. That's where apps come in — they're the extra pair of hands you didn't know you needed."

Now write a similar-style opening paragraph for a blog post about Shopify shipping apps.

This is one of the most powerful techniques. When you find a writing style you like, save examples of it and feed them to Claude.

Pillar 5: ITERATION — Refine Through Conversation

Never expect perfection on the first try. Plan for 2-3 rounds of refinement.

Effective refinement messages:

- "Good structure, but the tone is too formal. Make it sound like a friendly advisor, not a textbook."
- "The intro is too long. Cut it to 2 sentences maximum."
- "You mentioned features X and Y but missed Z. Add a paragraph about Z after the second section."
- "This reads like it's written by AI. Make it more human — add a rhetorical question and a short, punchy sentence."
- "I like paragraphs 1 and 3. Rewrite paragraph 2 to match their energy."

Ineffective refinement messages:

- "Make it better" (too vague)
- "I don't like it" (no direction)
- "Try again" (gives Claude nothing to work with)

2.3 Hands-On Exercises

Exercise 2.1 — The Vague vs. Specific Experiment

Step 1: Open a new chat. Type this vague prompt:

Write about a Shopify app.

Save the output.

Step 2: Open another new chat. Type this specific prompt:

You are a Shopify app expert writing for a blog that targets small business owners running their first online store.

Write a 200-word product overview of Klaviyo, the email marketing app for Shopify.

Requirements:
- Tone: Professional but friendly, like explaining to a smart friend
- Focus on: The #1 pain point it solves (merchants struggling to send targeted email campaigns without technical skills)
- Include: One specific feature that makes Klaviyo stand out
- Format: Short paragraphs (2-3 sentences max), no bullet points
- Avoid: Jargon, buzzwords, phrases like "game-changer" or "powerful tool"

Step 3: Compare both outputs side by side.

- [x] **Reflection: Write down 3 specific differences you notice between the outputs. Which one is closer to publishable?**
- The first answer doesn't actually write content: The first response only asks a clarifying question ("What kind of Shopify app content…?") without actually creating content about a Shopify app, as the prompt requested. The second response provides complete content, including an approximately 200-word overview of Klaviyo.
- The level of compliance with the prompt's detailed requirements: The second prompt includes very specific requirements: a professional but friendly tone, a focus on the biggest pain point, a highlighted key feature, short paragraphs (2–3 sentences), and no buzzwords. The second response meets almost all of these criteria. The first response meets none of them because it never begins writing the actual content.
- Targeting the right audience: The second response clearly targets new store owners and explains the issue in simple terms, making it suitable for first-time online shop owners. The first response does not define or address any specific target audience.

Exercise 2.2 — Role Experiment

Open a new chat. You'll write about the **same topic** from three different roles.

Prompt 1:

You are a Shopify store owner who has been using Oberlo for 6 months.
Write a 100-word honest review of your experience.

Prompt 2 (new chat):

You are a tech journalist who covers e-commerce tools.
Write a 100-word analysis of Oberlo's position in the Shopify app market.

Prompt 3 (new chat):

You are a content writer creating a beginner-friendly guide.
Write a 100-word explanation of what Oberlo does and who it's for.

- [x] **Reflection: How did the role change the vocabulary, perspective, and depth of each response? Write a note about which role produces content closest to what you'll need for your work.**

The three roles above represent three different ways of approaching content.

- Role 1 (Shopify store owner): This role uses simple, everyday language and focuses heavily on personal experience. The perspective is subjective, often shaped by emotions and hands-on lessons learned. It's ideal for writing case studies, testimonials, or real user experience (UX) stories because it feels authentic and relatable.
- Role 2 (Tech journalist): This role uses more analytical and systematic vocabulary, with terms like "market leader" or "platform integration." The tone is more neutral and strategic, often evaluating competitive positioning, Shopify's decisions, and broader market trends. It may reference ecosystem players such as Shopify, DSers, or Spocket to provide context. This role works best for trend analysis, industry insights, and strategic blog content.
- Role 3 (Content writer): This role prioritizes clarity and accessibility. The language is easy to understand, avoids heavy jargon, and focuses on explaining what the product is and who it's for. It's especially suitable for beginner guides, landing pages, and pillar content.

For my work, I believe combining all three roles can help me create higher-quality content. I can use the mindset of a content writer as the foundation, ensuring my articles are clear, structured, and easy to follow. Then, I can borrow the perspective of a store owner to add real-world scenarios and genuine pain points, such as slow shipping times or inconsistent product quality. This makes the content more practical and relatable rather than purely theoretical. On top of that, I can layer in the analytical depth of a tech journalist by looking at the broader Shopify ecosystem, the transition to DSers, or the competitive landscape shaped by tools like Spocket.

The key is to maintain a consistent voice: friendly, clear, insightful… If I can successfully blend these three roles, I believe I can build strong authority for myself within the Shopify app niche.

Exercise 2.3 — The Style-Matching Exercise

Step 1: Find a paragraph from a blog post or article whose writing style you admire (ideally about e-commerce or Shopify). Copy it.

Step 2: Open a new chat and use this prompt:

Here is a writing sample that represents the style and tone I want to match:

"[PASTE YOUR PARAGRAPH HERE]"

Now, in the same style and tone, write a 150-word introduction for a blog post titled "5 Best Shopify Apps for Inventory Management in 2026."

Step 3: Compare Claude's output with the original sample. How close is the style match?

Step 4: If it's not close enough, give Claude feedback:

The tone is close but not quite right. The original is more [specific feedback].
Adjust and try again.

- [x] **Reflection: How many rounds of feedback did it take to get a style match you're happy with? Save the final prompt — this becomes a reusable template.**

It took me ~2 rounds to get the style and tone I needed. Overall, Claude's results were quite positive; I was satisfied with the content I received without having to explain it in such detail as when using ChatGPT. Sometimes with ChatGPT, I had to provide much more detailed prompts, but still didn't get the desired results.

Exercise 2.4 — The Iterative Refinement Chain

This exercise walks you through a realistic editing workflow with Claude.

Round 1 — Get the first draft:

Write a 250-word blog post introduction about why Shopify store owners need a good SEO app. Target audience: store owners who know what SEO is but haven't done much about it. Tone: motivating and practical.

Round 2 — Refine the tone:

This is solid but reads a bit like a lecture. I want the reader to feel like they're getting advice from a friend who happens to be an SEO expert.

Rewrite with that energy.

Round 3 — Tighten the structure:

Better. Now tighten it:
- Cut the first sentence (it's too generic)
- Start with the most compelling point
- End with a clear bridge into the rest of the article
- Keep it under 200 words

Round 4 — Final polish:

Almost there. Change "optimize your store" to something less jargon-y.
And the last sentence feels abrupt — make it flow more naturally into
what comes next.

- [x] **Save all 4 versions. Notice how each round made the content meaningfully better. This is how professionals use Claude — not as a one-shot generator, but as a collaborative process.**

2.4 The Anatomy of a Great Content Prompt — Template

Here’s a fill-in-the-blank template you can use for any content task:

[ROLE]
You are a [specific expertise] writing for [publication/blog name].

[CONTEXT]
Our audience is [who they are]. They care about [what matters to them].
Their main challenge is [pain point].

[TASK]
Write a [word count] [content type: intro/outline/full section/meta description]
about [topic].

[SPECIFICS]
- Tone: [describe]
- Format: [paragraphs/bullets/headings/etc.]
- Must include: [specific points to cover]
- Must avoid: [things to exclude]

- Goal: [what this content should achieve]

[EXAMPLE — optional]
Here's a sample of the style I want:
"[paste example]"

- [x] **Task: Save this template somewhere accessible. You'll use it every day.**

Day 2 Checklist

- [x] Read and understood the Five Pillars of Prompting
- [x] Completed Exercise 2.1 (vague vs. specific)
- [x] Completed Exercise 2.2 (role experiment)
- [x] Completed Exercise 2.3 (style matching)
- [x] Completed Exercise 2.4 (iterative refinement chain)
- [x] Saved the prompt template for daily use
- [x] Written reflections on all exercises

DAY 3 — Claude as Your Content Writing Partner

Today's objective: Learn to use Claude across every stage of the content writing process — from ideation to final polish. By the end of today, you'll have produced a complete article draft using Claude at every step.

3.1 The Content Creation Pipeline with Claude

Here's how Claude fits into a professional content workflow:

```
IDEATION ——> RESEARCH ——> OUTLINING ——> DRAFTING ——> EDITING ——>
POLISHING
   |          |          |          |          |          |
 Claude     Claude +   Claude     Claude     Claude +    Claude
 helps a    YOU verify helps a    helps a    YOUR eye    helps a
  lot          lot       lot                   lot
```

Notice: **research** and **editing** are where YOUR human judgment is most critical. Claude can assist, but you lead.

3.2 Stage 1 — Ideation & Brainstorming

This is where Claude

de shines brightest. It can generate dozens of ideas in seconds.

Prompt: Topic Brainstorming

I need blog post ideas for a Shopify-focused blog. Our readers are small-to-medium Shopify store owners.

Generate 15 blog post ideas about Shopify apps for the following categories:
- 5 about email marketing apps
- 5 about inventory management apps
- 5 about SEO/marketing apps

For each idea, include:
1. A working title (SEO-friendly, under 60 characters)
2. The target reader (who specifically would search for this)
3. The main angle (what makes this post different from generic listicles)

Prompt: Angle Exploration

When you have a topic but need to find the right angle:

I'm writing about Shopify email marketing apps. Give me 8 different angles I could take for this topic, ranging from beginner-focused to advanced.
For each angle, tell me:
- The specific title
- Who it's for
- Why someone would click on it over a competing article

Exercise 3.1 — Brainstorm Session

- [x] Use the brainstorming prompt above to generate 15 ideas
- [x] Pick the 3 ideas you think are strongest
- [x] For each of those 3, ask Claude to give you 5 different title options
- [x] Select your favorite title for each

- [x] **Save your final 3 titles — you'll use one for today's assignment**
- Klaviyo vs Omnisend for Shopify: Which One Fits Your Store?
- How to Sync Shopify Inventory Across Multiple Channels
- 5 Best Shopify SEO Apps to Boost Organic Traffic

3.3 Stage 2 — Research Assistance

Important disclaimer: Claude is a research *assistant*, not a research *source*. Use it to organize your thinking, generate research questions, and understand concepts — but always verify facts yourself.

Prompt: Research Kickstart

I'm writing a blog post titled "[Your Title Here]".

Help me research this by:
1. List the key topics and subtopics I should cover
2. What questions would a reader have about this topic?
3. What are common misconceptions about this topic?
4. What data points or statistics would strengthen this article?
   (Flag which ones I should verify independently)
5. Who are the main competitors/alternatives I should mention?

Prompt: Understanding a Shopify App

I need to write about [App Name], a Shopify app for [category].

Based on your knowledge, help me understand:
1. What problem does this app solve?
2. Who is the ideal user?
3. What are its core features?
4. What would potential drawbacks be?
5. What apps do people typically compare it to?

IMPORTANT: Flag anything you're not confident about so I can verify.

After getting Claude's response: Go to the actual Shopify App Store listing, the app's official website, and recent reviews to verify and update everything Claude told you.

Exercise 3.2 — Research the Right Way

- [x] Pick one of your 3 titles from Exercise 3.1

5 Best Shopify SEO Apps to Boost Organic Traffic

- [x] Use the “Research Kickstart” prompt

I'm writing a blog post titled: "5 Best Shopify SEO Apps to Boost Organic Traffic". Help me research this by

1. List the key topics and subtopics I should cover
2. What questions would a reader have about this topic?
3. What are common misconceptions about this topic?
4. What data points or statistics would strengthen this article? (Flag which ones I should verify independently)
5. Who are the main competitors/alternatives I should mention?
- [x] Use the “Understanding a Shopify App” prompt for each app you’ll mention

I need to write about "Avada AI SEO Image Optimizer", a Shopify app for SEO. Based on your knowledge, help me understand:

1. What problem does this app solve?
2. Who is the ideal user?
3. What are its core features?
4. What would potential drawbacks be?
5. What apps do people typically compare it to? IMPORTANT: Flag anything you're not confident about so I can verify.
- [x] Go to the actual Shopify App Store and verify Claude’s information
- [x] Note what Claude got right and what needed correction
- [x] **Keep your research notes — you’ll need them for the outline**

3.4 Stage 3 — Outlining

Claude is excellent at creating structured outlines. This is one of the highest-ROI uses of Claude for content writing.

Prompt: Detailed Blog Post Outline

Create a detailed outline for a blog post titled "[Your Title]".

Context:
- Target audience: [who]
- Blog style: [describe your blog's vibe]
- Word count target: [X words] for the full article

- Goal: [inform/convert/educate/compare]

The outline should include:
1. A compelling hook for the introduction (2-3 options)
2. H2 and H3 subheadings for every section
3. Key points to cover under each heading (as bullet points)
4. Where to place data, examples, or screenshots
5. A clear conclusion with CTA
6. Suggested meta description (under 155 characters)

Make the structure scannable — our readers skim before they read.

Exercise 3.3 — Build Your Outline

- [x] Use the outline prompt above for your chosen blog post topic
- [x] Review the outline critically — does the flow make sense? Would you read this article?
- [x] Ask Claude to adjust anything that doesn't feel right (e.g., "Move section 3 before section 2" or "Add a FAQ section at the end")
- [x] Finalize your outline
- [x] **Save it — you're drafting from this outline next**

3.5 Stage 4 — Drafting

Here's the key mindset: **draft section by section, not the whole article at once.**

Why? Because:

- Shorter prompts produce more focused, higher-quality output
- You can give section-specific instructions
- You maintain more control over the flow
- It's easier to iterate on individual sections

Prompt: Section-by-Section Drafting

Based on this outline, write the [SECTION NAME] section.

[Paste the relevant section from your outline]

Requirements:
- Word count for this section: [X] words
- Tone: [describe]

- Include: [specific points, examples, data]
- Format: [short paragraphs, bullets, etc.]
- This section should flow from the previous section which ended with:
  "[paste last sentence of previous section]"

Prompt: Introduction Writing (Special Attention)

The intro is the most important part. Give it extra care:

Write 3 different introductions for this blog post (each 100-150 words):

Title: [title]
Topic: [brief summary]
Audience: [who]

Version 1: Start with a pain point / problem the reader faces
Version 2: Start with a surprising fact or statistic (you can make up a plausible stat — I'll verify and replace with a real one)
Version 3: Start with a relatable scenario / story

Each intro should hook the reader in the first sentence and clearly preview what the article will cover.

Exercise 3.4 — Draft Your Article

- [x] Draft the introduction (try the 3-version approach above, pick your favorite)
- [x] Draft each body section one at a time using the section-by-section prompt
- [x] Draft the conclusion
- [x] Assemble all sections into one document
- [x] Read the full draft from top to bottom — does it flow? Mark sections that feel disconnected
- [x] **Save your first complete draft**

3.6 Stage 5 — Editing & Polishing

This is where your 3 years of writing experience matters most. Claude can help you edit, but YOU decide what's good.

Prompt: Self-Critique (Ask Claude to Find Weaknesses)

Here's my draft blog post. Read it as a critical editor and give me:

1. Overall assessment (1-2 sentences)
2. The 3 weakest sentences — explain why they're weak
3. Any sections that feel repetitive or could be tighter
4. Whether the intro hooks the reader effectively
5. Whether the conclusion feels complete and actionable
6. Suggestions for improving readability (sentence length variety, transitions, etc.)

[PASTE YOUR DRAFT]

Prompt: Tone and Readability Check

Review this draft for tone consistency and readability:

1. Flag any sentences that sound too formal/stiff
2. Flag any sentences that sound too casual/sloppy
3. Flag any jargon a non-technical reader might not understand
4. Rate the overall readability (1-10) and suggest improvements

[PASTE YOUR DRAFT]

Prompt: Final Polish

Polish this paragraph. Keep my voice and meaning, but improve:
- Sentence flow and rhythm
- Word choice (remove filler words, replace weak verbs)
- Transitions between sentences

Don't rewrite it entirely — make surgical improvements.

[PASTE PARAGRAPH]

Exercise 3.5 — Edit and Polish

- [x] Paste your full draft into Claude and use the Self-Critique prompt
- [x] Make the changes you agree with (ignore what you don’t agree with — YOU are the editor)
- [x] Use the Tone and Readability Check prompt
- [x] Polish the 3 weakest paragraphs using the Final Polish prompt
- [x] Read the final version out loud. Does it sound natural?
- [x] **Save your edited draft**

Day 3 Assignment

By end of Day 3, you should have:

- [x] 3 blog post titles from brainstorming
- [x] Research notes for one topic (with fact-check annotations)
- [x] A detailed outline
- [x] A complete first draft (~600-800 words)
- [x] An edited second draft

Submit all of these for review.

https://docs.google.com/document/d/19BnCC2RBi2T-pcURDl9GmJbtbEdh-QA936zzsQvOdqo/edit?usp=sharing

DAY 4: Strengths, Limitations & The Fact-Checking Discipline

Today's objective: Develop a realistic understanding of where Claude excels and where it fails. Build a systematic fact-checking process that becomes second nature.

4.1 Where Claude Excels (Use It Heavily Here)

These are tasks where Claude consistently performs at a high level:

Generating Ideas and Options

Claude can produce 10 headline variations, 15 blog angles, or 20 CTA options in seconds. It's tireless for brainstorming.

Try it now:

Give me 10 different ways to start a blog post about Shopify SEO apps.
Each opening sentence should use a different technique
(question, statistic, bold statement, scenario, analogy, etc.)

Structural Work

Outlines, frameworks, article flow, section organization — Claude is excellent at structure.

Try it now:

I have these 6 points to make in my article. What's the most logical order
to present them for maximum reader engagement?

1. [point 1]
2. [point 2]
3. [point 3]
4. [point 4]
5. [point 5]
6. [point 6]

Rephrasing and Tone Adjustment

Give Claude a paragraph and ask it to make it more formal, more casual, shorter, punchier, simpler — it does this very well.

Try it now:

Rewrite this paragraph in 3 different tones:
1. Casual and witty (like a blog for millennials)
2. Professional and authoritative (like a B2B whitepaper)
3. Simple and clear (like explaining to a complete beginner)

"[Paste any paragraph from your Day 3 draft]"

Format Conversion

Claude can convert content between formats reliably:

- Blog post to social media posts
- Long paragraph to bullet points
- Feature list to comparison table
- Article to email newsletter summary

Try it now:

Convert this blog post section into:
1. A 280-character Twitter/X post

2. A LinkedIn post (3-4 short paragraphs with line breaks)
3. A bullet-point summary for an email newsletter

[Paste a section from your Day 3 draft]

Explaining Complex Topics Simply

Claude is excellent at taking complicated concepts and making them accessible.

Try it now:

Explain how Shopify app integrations work (webhooks, APIs, embedded apps)
in a way that a non-technical store owner would understand.
Use a restaurant analogy to make it click.

- [x] **Complete all five "Try it now" exercises above. Save outputs you find particularly useful.**

4.2 Where Claude Struggles (Verify Everything Here)

Factual Claims About Specific Products

The problem: Claude will confidently state pricing, feature lists, and ratings that may be outdated or simply wrong.

Exercise 4.1 — The Pricing Test:

What is the current pricing for these Shopify apps?
1. Klaviyo
2. PageFly
3. Oberlo
4. Judge.me
5. Tidio

For each, list all available plans and their monthly prices.

Now go check every single price against the actual app listings. Record your findings:

App	Claude's Price	Actual Price	Accurate ?
Klaviyo	• Free plan		
• Paid start at $20/month	• Free to install		
• **SMS $15**/ month			
• **Email $20**/ month	F		
PageFly	• Free plan		
• Paid plans start from $24/month			
• The Unlimited plan costs $99/month	• Free plan		
• **Pay as you go $18**/ month			
• **Unlimited $99**/ month	F		
Oberlo	Oberlo is no longer available.	Oberlo is no longer available.	T
Judge.me	• Free plan		
• Premium plan costs just $15 per month	• Free plan		
• $15/month	T		
Tidio	• Starter ($29/mo),		
• Growth ($59--$349/mo),			
• Plus ($749/mo),			
• Premium (from $2,999/mo)	• Free		
• **Customer Service $29**/ month			
• **Flows 29**/ month			
• **Lyro AI Chatbot $39**/ month	F		

- [x] **Complete this table. What percentage did Claude get right?**

Claude's accuracy: 40%

Statistics and Data Points

The problem: Claude sometimes generates plausible-sounding statistics that are completely fabricated.

Exercise 4.2 — The Statistics Test:

Give me 5 statistics about Shopify e-commerce that I could use in a blog post.
Include the source for each.

Now try to verify each statistic and its source. You'll likely find:

- Some statistics are real but slightly misquoted
- Some sources don't exist or don't contain the claimed statistic
- Some numbers are in the right ballpark but wrong in specifics
- [x] **Document which stats were verifiable and which weren't.**

Recent Events and Changes

The problem: Claude's training data has a cutoff date. It doesn't know about things that happened recently.

Exercise 4.3 — The Recency Test:

What major changes has Shopify made to its App Store policies in the last 6 months?
What new Shopify apps have launched and gained popularity recently?

Cross-reference with Shopify's actual changelog and recent tech news.

- [x] **Note what Claude knew vs. what it was guessing about.**

Unique Opinions and Original Insights

The problem: Claude generates consensus-level opinions. It won't give you a genuinely unique, controversial, or original take. Its "opinions" are aggregated averages of what it's seen in training data.

Why this matters for your work: If every article you write sounds like it could have been written by anyone, you won't stand out. Your original perspective, based on real experience and research, is what makes content valuable.

Exercise 4.4 — The Originality Test:

What's your honest, opinionated take on whether Shopify store owners should use all-in-one apps or best-of-breed specialized apps?

Notice: Claude will give a balanced, both-sides answer. It almost never takes a strong stand. In your writing, YOU need to have a point of view. Use Claude for the scaffolding, but inject your own opinions.

- [x] **Write a short paragraph (your own words, no Claude) giving YOUR actual take on the all-in-one vs. specialized apps question. This is the kind of original perspective your articles need.**

If I had to pick a side, I'd go with best-of-breed specialized apps every time. All-in-one apps sound effective, but in reality, they're often broad but shallow; they have many features but lack depth. After all, no app truly excels at handling email, SMS, loyalty programs, reviews, upselling, and analytics all at once. You'll be paying for apps you'll barely use, while missing out on several features that actually generate revenue. That's exactly why best-of-breed specialized apps win; they're built to focus on a core function. For example, a dedicated loyalty app almost always has stronger reward logic, more flexible rules, and deeper integration with Shopify than a "loyalty tab" within a marketing suite. In my opinion, you should invest in the best tools in each area for 2-3 revenue-generating pillars (usually email/SMS, loyalty programs, and reviews), and rely on Shopify's native features for everything else instead of stacking multiple apps for problems that Shopify can solve effectively.

4.3 The Fact-Checking System

Based on what you've learned today, here's a systematic process to follow for every piece of content:

The Traffic Light System

When reviewing Claude's output, mentally tag every claim:

- **GREEN (safe to use):** General explanations, conceptual descriptions, structural elements, writing style adjustments. These are almost always reliable.
- **YELLOW (verify before using):** Specific feature claims, “best practices,” comparisons between products, any recommendation. These are *usually* right but sometimes wrong.
- **RED (always verify independently):** Pricing, statistics, review counts, release dates, specific percentages, quotes, company claims, policy details. These are frequently wrong or outdated.

Verification Checklist for Every Article

Before submitting any article, confirm:

- [ ] All app pricing matches current App Store listings
- [ ] All feature claims are verified against the app’s official page
- [ ] All statistics have a verifiable, real source
- [ ] App availability is confirmed (is it still active on the Shopify App Store?)
- [ ] Any review counts or ratings are current
- [ ] Links work and go where they should
- [ ] No made-up tools, features, or integrations

Day 4 Checklist

- [x] Completed all 5 “Claude Excels” exercises
- [x] Completed Exercise 4.1 (pricing test with comparison table)
- [x] Completed Exercise 4.2 (statistics verification)
- [x] Completed Exercise 4.3 (recency test)
- [x] Completed Exercise 4.4 (originality test — wrote your own paragraph)
- [x] Understood and saved the Traffic Light fact-checking system
- [x] Written reflections: “My top 3 rules for using Claude responsibly”
- Use Claude to support thinking, not to replace humans.
- Verify all the information provided by Claude regarding data, pricing, app availability. etc.
- Don’t provide Claude with highly sensitive information such as confidential documents, passwords, etc.

DAY 5: Building Your Workflow & Final Project

Today’s objective: Build your personal prompt library, configure Claude for efficient daily use, and complete your final project demonstrating everything you’ve learned.

5.1 Your Personal Prompt Library

A prompt library is a document where you save your best-performing prompts so you can reuse and refine them over time. This is what separates casual Claude users from power users.

Build Your Library Now

Create a document (Google Doc, Notion, or simple text file) with these categories. Fill in each one by adapting the templates below to your specific writing style and needs.

Prompt 1: Blog Post Ideation

You are a content strategist for a Shopify-focused blog. Our readers are
[audience description].

Generate [number] blog post ideas about [topic/category].

For each idea, provide:
- SEO-friendly title (under 60 characters)
- Target keyword
- Reader intent (informational/commercial/navigational)
- One-sentence angle that differentiates this from competing articles

Prioritize topics with clear search intent over trend pieces.

Prompt 2: Article Outline

Create a detailed outline for: "[Title]"

Context:
- Audience: [who]
- Word count: [target]
- Content type: [listicle/how-to/review/comparison/guide]
- Tone: [describe]
- SEO keyword: [primary keyword]

Include:
- Hook options for the intro (give 2)
- H2 and H3 subheadings
- Key points per section (bullets)

- Where to insert examples, screenshots, or data
- Conclusion with CTA
- Meta description (under 155 characters)
- 3 internal linking opportunities

Prompt 3: Section Drafting

Write the [section name] section of my article.

Context from outline:
[Paste relevant outline section]

Requirements:
- [X] words
- Tone: [describe]
- The previous section ended with: "[last sentence]"
- This section should transition smoothly from that

Formatting: short paragraphs (2-3 sentences), use subheadings if the section is over 200 words.

Prompt 4: Introduction Writer

Write 3 intro options (each 100-150 words) for:

Title: "[title]"
Audience: [who]
Main value of the article: [what the reader gets from reading]

Option A: Start with the reader's pain point
Option B: Start with a surprising insight or counterintuitive claim
Option C: Start with a micro-story or relatable scenario

Each must hook in the first sentence and preview the article's value.

Prompt 5: Editing & Improvement

Review this section as a senior content editor. Don't rewrite it — give me specific, actionable feedback:

1. Mark the weakest sentence and explain why
2. Identify any filler words or unnecessary phrases to cut
3. Check if the opening sentence of this section earns the reader's attention

4. Rate clarity (1-10) and suggest one improvement
5. Rate engagement (1-10) and suggest one improvement

[PASTE SECTION]

Prompt 6: SEO Enhancement

For an article titled "[title]" targeting the keyword "[keyword]":

1. Suggest 5 related keywords to naturally include
2. Write an SEO meta title (under 60 characters)
3. Write an SEO meta description (under 155 characters)
4. Suggest 3 questions to answer in the article (for featured snippet potential)
5. Recommend where in the article to place the primary keyword naturally

Prompt 7: Content Repurposing

Based on this blog post, create:

1. A Twitter/X thread (5-7 tweets)
2. A LinkedIn post (professional tone, 150 words)
3. An email subject line + preview text + 3-sentence email body
4. 3 pull quotes for social media graphics

Original article:
[PASTE ARTICLE]

Prompt 8: Comparison Table Builder

Create a comparison table for these Shopify apps: [App 1], [App 2], [App 3]

Compare on these dimensions:
- Starting price (free plan? lowest paid plan?)
- Best for (what type of merchant)
- Standout feature
- Shopify App Store rating
- Number of reviews (approximate)
- Ease of setup (beginner-friendly or technical?)
- Key limitation

Format as a markdown table. FLAG any data point you are not confident about.

- [x] **Task: Copy all 8 prompt templates into your prompt library document. Customize at least 3 of them with your specific audience, tone, and style preferences.**

Prompt 1: Blog Post Ideation

You are a content strategist for a Shopify-focused blog. Our readers are

Shopify store owners.

Generate 10 blog post ideas about Best Shopify SEO Apps

For each idea, provide:

- SEO-friendly title (under 60 characters)
- Target keyword
- Reader intent (informational/commercial/navigational)
- One-sentence angle that differentiates this from competing articles

Prioritize topics with clear search intent over trend pieces.

Prompt 2: Article Outline

Create a detailed outline for: "8 Best Shopify SEO Apps in 2026 (Tested)"

Context:

- Audience: Shopify store owners, ecommerce founders, dropshippers, and digital marketers who want to increase organic traffic and sales through SEO
- Word count: 2,500–3,500 words to ensure in-depth reviews, feature breakdowns, comparisons, FAQs, and strong topical authority
- Content type: Listicle + in-depth review with real testing insights and comparison elements
- Tone: Professional but friendly, like explaining to a smart friend, expert yet easy to understand, practical and data-driven, unbiased, conversion-focused, and actionable
- SEO keyword: Best Shopify SEO apps

Include:

- Hook options for the intro (give 2)
- H2 and H3 subheadings
- Key points per section (bullets)
- Where to insert examples, screenshots, or data
- Conclusion with CTA
- Meta description (under 155 characters)
- 3 internal linking opportunities

Prompt 4: Introduction Writer

Write 3 intro options (each 100-150 words) for:

Title: "8 Best Shopify SEO Apps in 2026 (Tested)"

Audience: Shopify store owners, ecommerce founders, dropshippers, and digital marketers who want to increase organic traffic and sales through SEO

Main value of the article: helping Shopify store owners quickly choose the right SEO app based on real testing instead of marketing claims.

Option A: Start with the reader's pain point

Option B: Start with a surprising insight or counterintuitive claim

Option C: Start with a micro-story or relatable scenario

Each must hook in the first sentence and preview the article's value.

5.2 Advanced Claude Features

Projects (Pro plan)

Projects let you give Claude persistent context — so it “remembers” your writing style, brand guidelines, and audience across conversations.

How to set up a project for your Shopify content work:

1. Click **“Projects”** in the sidebar
2. Create a new project: “Shopify Blog Content”
3. In the project instructions, add:
    - Your target audience description
    - Your blog’s tone and style guidelines
    - Any words/phrases to always use or always avoid
    - Example paragraphs of your ideal writing style
4. Upload reference documents:
    - Your style guide (if you have one)
    - 2-3 of your best published articles as examples
    - A list of Shopify apps you frequently write about

Now every conversation started within this project will automatically have this context. You won’t need to repeat your audience and tone preferences every time.

- [x] **Task: Set up your Shopify Blog Content project with at least a basic project instruction.**

File Uploads

You can upload files directly into a conversation for Claude to read and reference.

Useful for:

- Uploading a competitor's article and asking Claude to help you write something better
- Uploading an app's documentation for Claude to summarize
- Uploading your draft for editing feedback
- Uploading a CSV of keyword research data

How: Click the paperclip icon in the message input area. You can upload PDFs, text documents, images, and more.

- [x] **Task: Upload a document to Claude (any article or document) and ask Claude to summarize it in 3 bullet points.**

Claude Skills

What Are Claude Skills?

A "Skill" is a set of saved instructions inside a Project that teaches Claude how to do a specific job for you - consistently, every time, without you having to re-explain.

Think of it this way:

Without a Skill	With a Skill
Every new chat, you re-explain your audience, tone, and style	Claude already knows all of that — you just say "write the intro"
Claude gives generic output that needs heavy editing	Claude writes in YOUR voice from the first draft
You repeat the same correction ("don't use jargon") chat after chat	The correction is built in — Claude never uses jargon

Each writer on your team gets different outputs	Everyone gets consistent, on-brand content

In practical terms: A Skill = Project Instructions written in a specific way. You build Skills by writing detailed, structured instructions in the Project Instructions field. Claude follows these instructions in every conversation within that project.

5.3 Daily Workflow Recommendation

Here's a suggested daily workflow once you're comfortable:

Morning: Planning (15-20 min with Claude)

1. Open your Shopify Blog Content project
2. Discuss today's article topic with Claude
3. Use your Ideation prompt if you need a topic
4. Use your Outline prompt to build structure
5. Verify the outline makes sense for your audience

Midday: Drafting (1-2 hours with Claude)

1. Draft section by section using your Section Drafting prompt
2. After each section, read it and refine with Claude
3. Fact-check RED items as you go (don't leave it all for the end)
4. Assemble the full draft

Afternoon: Editing & Publishing (30-60 min, mostly you)

1. Use the Editing prompt for Claude's feedback
2. Apply your own editorial judgment
3. Final fact-check pass (pricing, features, links)
4. Run through the Verification Checklist
5. Use the SEO Enhancement prompt for meta tags
6. Publish

5.5 Final Project

This is your end-of-week assignment. It demonstrates everything you've learned.

The Brief

Write and submit a **complete, publish-ready blog post** (2,000-2,500 words) about a Shopify app of your choice.

Requirements

Content:

- Pick any Shopify app currently available in the App Store
- Choose your own angle (review, how-to, comparison, guide — up to you)
- All facts must be verified against real sources
- Must include at least one original opinion or insight (not from Claude)

Process:

- Use Claude at every stage (ideation, outline, drafting, editing)
- Use at least 3 different prompts from your prompt library

Deliverables (submit all 3):

1. **The final blog post** (ready to publish)
2. **Process log** — a document showing:
    - Which prompts you used at each stage
    - How many iterations each section took
    - What you changed from Claude's output and why
    - What you fact-checked and what corrections you made
    - What parts you wrote entirely yourself
3. **Self-assessment** answering:
    - What went well this week?
    - What do you still find difficult about using Claude?
    - Where did Claude save you the most time?
    - Where did Claude waste your time or lead you astray?
    - What's your personal #1 rule for using Claude going forward?
    - Rate your Claude confidence level (1-10) and explain why

Evaluation Criteria

Your final project will be evaluated on:

Criteria	Weight	What we're looking for
Content quality	30%	Is the blog post well-written, engaging, and valuable to the reader?
Factual accuracy	25%	Is every claim verified? Are pricing, features, and stats correct?

Claude usage	20%	Did you use Claude effectively at each stage? Are your prompts well-crafted?
Original voice	15%	Does the article have YOUR perspective, not just AI-generated text?
Process documentation	10%	Is your process log thorough and honest?

Day 5 Checklist

- [x] Built personal prompt library with all 8 templates (customized at least 3)
- [x] Explored Projects feature (or noted for when you upgrade to Pro)
- [x] Tested file upload feature
- [x] Tested Artifacts
- [x] Read and internalized the daily workflow
- [x] Read the tips section
- [x] Completed the final project (blog post + process log + self-assessment)
- [x] Submitted all deliverables for review

https://docs.google.com/document/d/1OMCA2-6n0B7_1q8AxGL7qpUxQWHCb4ilgymgtV8yDmQ/edit?usp=sharing

APPENDIX A — Prompt Template Library (Quick Reference)

#	Prompt Name	When to Use
1	Blog Post Ideation	Need topic ideas
2	Article Outline	Structuring a new article
3	Section Drafting	Writing individual sections
4	Introduction Writer	Crafting the opening
5	Editing & Improvement	Getting feedback on drafts
6	SEO Enhancement	Optimizing for search
7	Content Repurposing	Creating social/email from articles

APPENDIX B — Glossary

Term	Meaning
Prompt	The message you type to Claude. Better prompts = better outputs.
Hallucination	When Claude generates confident-sounding text that is factually wrong.
Context window	The amount of text Claude can “see” in a single conversation. Very long conversations may lose early context.
Artifact	A standalone document Claude creates in a side panel (outlines, full articles, code, etc.).
Project	A Claude Pro feature that lets you save persistent instructions and files that apply to all conversations within it.
Model	The “brain” behind Claude. Opus = most capable, Sonnet = good balance, Haiku = fastest.
Token	How Claude measures text length internally. Roughly, 1 token ≈ 0.75 words.
System prompt / Project instructions	Background instructions that guide Claude’s behavior for every message in a project.
Iteration	The process of refining Claude’s output through multiple rounds of feedback.
RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation)	A technique where Claude references uploaded documents to give more accurate answers. You do this naturally when you upload files.

APPENDIX C — Evaluation Rubrics

Blog Post Quality Rubric

Score	Description
9-10	Publication-ready. Engaging, well-structured, factually accurate, has original voice. Minimal edits needed.
7-8	Strong draft. Good structure and writing, minor factual or tonal issues. Light editing needed.
5-6	Acceptable draft. Decent content but lacks originality, has some factual issues, or tone is inconsistent. Moderate editing needed.
3-4	Needs significant work. Major structural issues, factual errors, or reads like raw AI output.
1-2	Not usable. Largely unedited Claude output, significant errors, or off-topic.

Claude Usage Rubric